KEN INFOTECH

Cine Ezhuthu

Brainstorm & Research Report

Ideas · Competitive landscape · Problems · Expansion

What already exists — and the gap

No single tool combines Indian-language handwriting recognition with screenplay formatting. The market splits across three categories — each covering part of the need, none covering all of it.

KEY — Strong coverage Not supported Partial / workaround only

Google ML Kit

Free, offline HWR — Tamil, Hindi, Mal.

Scrite

Indian screenplay tool, typing only (desktop)

Final Draft

Industry standard, English-first, no HWR

Nebo

Best HWR app — no Tamil/Hindi/Mal support

Apple Scribble

No Indian language support at all

Talking Draft

Voice-to-screenplay, Tamil+Hindi voice

Celtx / WriterDuet

English-first, no handwriting input

Ezhuthaani / Desh

Keyboard-level HWR only, not full-page

THE GAP:

No product combines Indian-language handwriting recognition + screenplay formatting in one mobile/tablet app. Scrite is the closest but is a desktop typing tool with zero handwriting input.

New feature ideas

INPUT

Voice + Pen hybrid mode

While writing a scene, the writer speaks dialogue aloud — voice is transcribed in parallel, pen handles action lines. Each input method stays in its lane.

WORKFLOW

Writer's journal mode

Free-form canvas before screenplay formatting kicks in. Ideas, rough notes, sketches all captured first — then 'convert to scene' on demand.

AI

Dialogue language tagger

Auto-detect when the writer switches languages mid-line. Tag each dialogue block by language so spell-check and export each correctly.

PLATFORM

Android + S-Pen support

Samsung Galaxy Tab with S-Pen is far more common than iPad among indie directors in India. Opens a much larger addressable market.

WORKFLOW

Scene card board

Swipeable index-card view of all scenes — drag to reorder. Mirrors how directors physically rearrange scenes on a wall.

AI

Character consistency checker

Flags when a character's name is spelled differently across scenes (common with HWR variance). Suggests one canonical spelling.

COMMUNITY

Regional script learning corpus

Opt-in: writers donate handwriting samples to improve the Tamil-cinema-specific recognition model for everyone over time.

EXPORT

Production breakdown export

After the script, auto-tag locations, characters per scene, day/night. Export a breakdown table — skips a separate production tool.

OLLABORATIO

Ink margin comments

Director shares a read-only link; collaborators leave handwritten annotations. Notes appear as ink overlays, not converted text.

INPUT

Storyboard sketch mode

Draw rough shot compositions directly in the scene — stick figures, camera angles. Stored as an ink layer, not converted to text.

Problems we face

Mixed-script on the same line

Tamil + English on one handwritten line is the hardest recognition case. ML Kit processes one language model at a time — mid-line switching needs custom segmentation logic that doesn't exist yet. This needs a real-handwriting prototype before any build commitment.

Correction loop must beat typing speed

If fixing a misrecognised word takes more than 2 taps, writers will abandon handwriting entirely. Scratch-out gesture, inline replacement, and auto-correction must all work flawlessly — the correction loop IS the product.

Offline model size vs. device storage

Tamil + Hindi + English ML Kit models add 20–80 MB per language on-device. Low-storage devices may refuse the install. Need progressive download, per-language toggles, and a clear model management UI.

Script confidentiality fears

Directors are extremely secretive about scripts before release. Any cloud sync must make the privacy guarantee front-and-centre — end-to-end encryption, no server-side storage, clear on-boarding messaging about what leaves the device.

Scrite is a real competitor now

Scrite supports 11 Indian languages, screenplay formatting, works offline, and is open-source with active development. It doesn't have handwriting today — but if it adds even basic stylus support, Cine Ezhuthu's moat narrows sharply. Speed to market matters.

Monetisation for a niche audience

Tamil/Malayalam indie directors are a passionate but small market. A monthly subscription may not work. Consider a one-time purchase (Rs.1,500-2,500) with a freemium tier where PDF/DOC export is the paywall.

Screenplay page count in non-Latin scripts

Industry standard: ~1 page = 1 minute of screen time, calibrated for Latin script. Tamil/Hindi text takes different horizontal space. Page count estimates will be wrong without script-aware calibration.

Writer onboarding — trust in accuracy

First-time recognition errors cause abandonment. Onboarding must set expectations, let the writer calibrate with 5–10 sentences, and visibly show accuracy improving. The first five minutes make or break retention.

Expansion ideas for future releases

Once the core handwriting + screenplay experience is proven, these features can be layered on in subsequent releases — each opening a new dimension of value without compromising V1 focus.

Telugu + Kannada

ML Kit already supports both. Opens Tollywood and Sandalwood markets — the next biggest regional film industries after Tamil and Malayalam.

Read-aloud with character voices

Each character gets a distinct TTS voice — writer hears the script performed. Borrowed from WriterDuet. Works fully offline with on-device TTS.

Paper import via camera

For writers with pages of handwritten notes — OCR via camera as a one-time import. Captures the pure-paper writer who won't switch to stylus.

WhatsApp script-sharing

One-tap share of a scene or full script as a clean PDF to WhatsApp. This is how production teams already communicate in India — meet them where they are.

Shot list generator

From a formatted scene, AI suggests a basic shot list (establishing, close-up, OTS). A starting point the director marks up by hand on the next page.

Revision colour tracking

WGA-style coloured revision marks on each draft — blue pages, pink pages. Standard in production; missing from most indie tools today.

Real-time collaboration

Director and writer work on the same scene simultaneously. Ink strokes from each user appear in different colours — like Google Docs for handwriting.

Voice dictation mode

Dictate dialogue with tap-to-label speakers — perform a scene and it auto-formats. Needs a separate engine from ML Kit; planned for V1.1 after HWR is stable.

Production breakdown export

Auto-tag locations, characters per scene, day/night after the script. Export a breakdown sheet for the production team directly — skips a separate app.

Key takeaways & recommended next steps

KEY TAKEAWAYS

The gap is real

No tool today combines Indian-language HWR + screenplay formatting on mobile. Scrite is the closest but is desktop-only and typing-based.

The engine exists

Google ML Kit handles Tamil, Hindi, English and Malayalam offline — the recognition foundation doesn't need to be built from scratch.

Android matters

Samsung Galaxy Tab + S-Pen is far more common than iPad among indie directors. An Android build opens a much larger market.

Speed is critical

Scrite is active and open-source. If it adds stylus support, the window narrows. Getting to market with a working HWR loop is the priority.

Monetisation needs work

A niche audience makes subscriptions risky. One-time purchase (Rs.1,500-2,500) with a freemium export paywall may convert better for this demographic.

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEPS

1. **Handwriting prototype**
   Collect 10–20 pages of real messy handwriting from the director. Run ML Kit on it. Measure accuracy before any engineering starts.
2. **Mixed-script test**
   Specifically test Tamil + English on the same line — the hardest case. This is the single biggest technical risk.
3. **Android decision**
   Decide iPad-first vs Android-first based on who the first 20 target users actually own. Don't assume iPad.
4. **Scrite gap analysis**
   Do a live walkthrough of Scrite with the director. Document exactly what it's missing — that list is the V1 feature spec.
5. **Pricing experiment**
   Interview 10 regional directors on willingness to pay. Rs.1,500 one-time vs Rs.200/month — which lands better?